3) Sicilian Broccoli Rabi Pasta by Susan Spiggle lover of Italy

Ingredients:

1 bunch of broccoli rabi; 10 ounces of pasta (fettuccine, spaghetti, rigatoni); ½ cup chopped onions; ½ cup pine nuts; ½ cup golden raisins; 2-4 Tabs extra virgin olive oil (EVOO); Salt and pepper to taste; ¾ cup freshly grated parmesan cheese

Directions: 1. Soften the raisins and pine nuts in lukewarm water for a few minutes. Drain. Hold. 2. Chop up the broccoli rabi into 1-inch pieces lengthwise. Sauté in 2 tablespoons of EVOO for 4-5 minutes until well wilted. Remove from pan. 3. Using the same pan, sauté the onions for 2-3 minutes over medium heat until softened. Then add the raisins and pine nuts and sauté for added 2-3 minutes. 4. Add the broccoli rabi back in and reserve. 5. Cook the pasta according to package directions in water salted to taste. 6. Drain the pasta, add the pine nuts, raisins, onions and broccoli rabi, extra EVOO to taste. Serve with the parmesan cheese. *

*This recipe was derived and modified from one that Inspector Montalbano's (an MHZ long running TV series set in Sicily) housekeeper made for him. Her version was made with broccoli, not broccoli rabi, and used toasted breadcrumbs in place of the parmesan cheese. Broccoli rabi contrasts nicely with the raisins. If broccoli, use one head. Cut off the florets into 1-2 inch pieces. Cook for 4 minutes. Reserve the water after removing and draining the broccoli. Cook the pasta in the reserved broccoli water according to package directions. Then proceed as in step 4.